across twenty or fifty overs. Others, like me, are good in the longer forms, but struggle to make an impact in T20.

As for me playing in The Hundred, the ECB's marketing-driven competition aimed at a new audience for cricket, which is scheduled to start in July 2020? I don't think so. Being in one of eight city-based franchise teams, playing a shortened hundred-ball form of the game, is a step too far. An old dog can only learn so many new tricks.

Innovation is no bad thing per se. Cricket has always had room for the experimental. Mushtaq Mohammad of Pakistan first tried out the switch-hit shot playing for Northamptonshire in the mid-seventies. Mike Gatting infamously attempted an impetuous reverse sweep in the 1987 World Cup final against Australia in Kolkata, deflecting Alan Border's first ball to wicketkeeper Greg Dyer in a key phase of a run chase that ended seven short.

Sometimes fortune favours the brave, or at least excuses the misguided. MS Dhoni, a law unto himself on a cricket field, will be forever associated with the helicopter shot, a fusion of timing and instinct. It involves a strong, quick-wristed flick off a fuller length ball, towards the leg side, and ends with the bat being twirled above the head.

Tekkers, as I think they say in football.

For me, the greatest advance was Kevin Pietersen's switched-hand reverse sweep, with which he deposited Scott Styris over the extra-cover boundary at the Riverside in June 2008. Just imagine, for a moment, how strange it would feel if you hit a shot with your wrong hand. It is such an unnatural act. Yet Kevin's shot also incorporated remarkably quick feet, an amazingly sharp brain and flexibility of body position that would have put most of us in traction. For good measure, he repeated the trick against a slower ball, a sequence that involved waiting in his reversed position and hitting it virtually straight over long off. No wonder Styris gawped with amazement before joining in the applause. Kevin had toyed with the shot in T20, but this was new territory, even for a batsman who had announced himself two years earlier with a reverse slog sweep off Muttiah Muralitharan into the Eric Hollies Stand at Edgbaston.

Some of the responses to the destruction he wrought in Durham were way over the top. MCC, guardian of the game's laws, announced it would be considering the shot's merits at a previously scheduled meeting. There was some frankly daft talk about bowlers changing from right to left arm in